

2.3.1 Buddhism

Religion and human relationships

Roles of men and women in the family	• Roles of men and women in a Buddhist family • Roles of men and women in the vihara
Marriage	• The ways in which the beliefs about marriage reflect and emphasise Buddhist beliefs within the local community • Responses to civil partnerships
Divorce	• Beliefs about the ethics of divorce • The variety of attitudes to divorce within Buddhist communities • Beliefs about the ethics of re-marriage
Sexual relationships and contraception	• Beliefs about sexual relationships • Beliefs about contraception • Celibacy and the monastic sangha

Religion and medical ethics

Attitudes to abortion	• Different attitudes towards abortion • Reasons for different attitudes
Attitudes to fertility treatment	• Responses to issues raised by fertility treatment and cloning



Attitudes to euthanasia and suicide	• Different attitudes towards euthanasia • Different attitudes towards suicide • Reasons for different attitudes
Using animals in medical research	• Beliefs about the use of animals in medical research

Religion, poverty and wealth

Religious views of wealth and the causes of hunger, poverty and disease	• Wealth • Causes of hunger, poverty and disease • Responses to the needs of the starving, the poor and the sick
Concern for others	• Buddhist teaching about caring for others • Understandings of 'charity' • Different ways charity is put into practice
The uses of money	• Teachings about the use of money (e.g. gambling, lending) • Giving to charity
Moral and immoral occupations	• Concept of moral and immoral • Teachings about moral and immoral occupations • Impact of teachings on believers